

Case Study — Williamstown Primary School

“Re-keying every kid into a different spreadsheet for every sport — that’s what I did before SSP. Then on race day I’d be writing finishing positions on a clipboard while a parent reads the times off a stopwatch. SSP cut a whole afternoon of work out of every carnival.” — [Quote pending — Patrick Gallivan, PE Coordinator, WPS]

At a glance

School	Williamstown Primary School
Location	Williamstown VIC 3016
Enrolment	~440 students
Sports run on platform	Cross-Country, Athletics, Swimming
First event	Williamstown District Cross-Country, 7 May 2026
Outcome	192 students timed across 6 races, results published live, zero re-keying, 15-minute results turnaround at the finish line

The problem

Before School Sport Portal, Williamstown Primary’s sport admin looked like every other primary school’s:

- A spreadsheet of students copy-pasted from Compass each February.
- A second spreadsheet for swimming carnival entries.
- A third spreadsheet for athletics carnival.
- A fourth for cross-country.
- A clipboard of finish times on race day, transcribed by hand into the spreadsheet that night.
- A printed-out PDF of results pinned to the staffroom noticeboard the following day.

Each sport meant another export, another import, another round of “is this kid in the right age group?” arguments at sign-on.

District-level was worse. Williamstown District Cross-Country brings 8 schools and 192 runners to a single morning at McIvor Reserve. The convening school had to collect Excel sheets from every other school, paste them into a master spreadsheet, generate bib numbers manually, and reconcile times scribbled by lane judges with a master clock kept on someone’s phone.

By the time the results were emailed out to other schools’ coordinators, it was Friday evening. Parents heard times by word of mouth from their kids on Thursday afternoon and were mostly wrong.

What changed

WPS uploaded its student roster once into School Sport Portal in early 2026. From that single roster:

- **Cross-country house event** — random bib allocation, lane assignments, and finishing-line marshal sheets generated in 5 minutes.

- **District XC carnival** — eight participating schools’ rosters loaded into one shared timing app. Each school’s PE coordinator set their entries from the master roster — no spreadsheet exchange, no re-keying.
- **Race-day** — Carnival Timing app on a phone at the finish line. Marshal taps a 4-digit bib, the time is captured, the runner appears on the public results page within seconds.
- **No-bibs fallback** — when bibs went missing from a heat, the marshal tapped a name picker filtered to runners in the active race. Identification took 2–3 seconds per finisher.
- **Public results** — sportcarnival.com.au/wd26 updates live as each finisher crosses the line. Parents at the side of the course refresh and see their kid’s time before the next race finishes.

The numbers

Metric	Pre-SSP	With SSP
Time to set up a carnival from roster	~3 hours	8 minutes
Cross-school spreadsheet re-keying	~4 hours per district carnival	0
Finish-line transcription errors	5–10 per carnival typical	0 (live capture)
Time from final whistle to published results	24–48 hours	<5 minutes
Parents asking “what was my kid’s time?”	Constant for 48 hours	None — they already know
Cost	Volunteer time + printer costs	\$440/yr (440 students × \$1)

What WPS uses now

- **School Sport Portal** — single roster, sport calendar, parent-view, end-of-season reporting.
- **Carnival Timing** — race-day app with Marshal mode, Lane Timer, Video Finish, Spectator view. House-points engine for athletics carnivals.
- **SportCarnival** — public results page at sportcarnival.com.au/wd26 (Williamstown District) and a non-public school page at /williamstownps for school-level events.

The same platform now serves WPS as a **school**, the **Williamstown District** convener, and the **Hobsons Bay Division**. Same roster. Same bib numbers. Same scoring engine. Same public page.

What other schools should know

If you run district sport for a cluster of primary schools, **the convening school benefits most**. SSP eliminates the cross-school spreadsheet exchange entirely. If you don’t convene, you still get to keep your own roster from year to year and never re-enter a student who’s already on the platform from a previous carnival.

Most schools join because their PE coordinator is sick of the spreadsheet dance. They stay because parents stop asking what their kid’s time was — they can already see it.

Try it

- Public demo: <https://sportcarnival.com.au/> (fictional district, simulated live results)
- Williamstown District live page: <https://sportcarnival.com.au/wd26>
- Carnival Timing app: <https://carnivaltiming.com> (request a trial code: hello@carnivaltiming.com)
- Get started: <https://schoolsportportal.com.au>

Case study version 1.0 — May 2026. Quote and final figures to be confirmed with Williamstown Primary School after the 7 May 2026 District XC carnival.